BUSINESS SYSTEM · INTERNAL STRATEGY DOC

Premium Content System Studio

A productized retainer business for a 2-partner video & branding studio in Tunisia. Six-month roadmap from zero to **10 000+ TND MRR**, anchored by a sharp ICP and high-ticket positioning.

Target: 3 000 TND/mo by month 3 · 10 000+ TND/mo by month 6 | **Team:** 2 partners (editing + branding + marketing) | **Market:** Tunisian DTC e-commerce + premium service businesses

1 · Strategic foundation

The one assumption everything rests on

This entire system depends on **one strategic call**: who you sell to, and at what ticket. Get this wrong and the offer, acquisition, and delivery all collapse. Get it right and 3 000 TND/mo is the floor, not the ceiling.

> **The qualifier rule (apply to every prospect):**
> Their average customer must be worth **≥ 1 500 TND** to them. If yes → a 2 500 TND/mo retainer is a rounding error on their P&L. If no → you're selling a Rolex to someone who needed a watch, and they will churn at month 2.

Why "local Tunisian businesses" mostly fails the qualifier

A neighborhood café, retail shop, or generalist service has a customer LTV of 50–300 TND. They cannot rationally pay a premium retainer — even if they want to, the unit economics break. **Only a slice of "local Tunisia" works: high-LTV service businesses.**

Refined ICP — two segments, one qualifier

Segment	Examples	Why they pay premium
Primary **Tunisian DTC e-commerce**	Cosmetics, skincare, modest fashion, streetwear, supplements, home/lifestyle, specialty F&B. Brands doing 25k+ TND/mo, running Meta ads.	They already spend on ads → reallocating budget to creative is easy. Need *volume* of branded video (UGC, product, ads, organic). LTV = 200–600 TND × repeat.
Secondary **Premium services**	Aesthetic / dental / derma clinics, IVF centers, real-estate agencies & promoters, private schools and training centers, boutique hotels, law / accounting / consulting firms.	One client is worth 3 000–50 000 TND. Brand image is a moat. Already buying marketing — just badly.
Excluded **Low-LTV local**	Restaurants, retail shops, generalist services — anything with avg ticket < 200 TND.	Math doesn't support a premium retainer. Will churn and damage your case-study slots.

Shared trait: high customer LTV. That's what justifies premium pricing. You're not selling video — you're selling *more revenue per ad / per square meter / per chair*.

2 · Productized offer (4 SKUs)

	Identity Sprint	Content OS	Performance Partner	Ad Creative Pack e-com
Price	1 800 TND one-shot	**2 500 TND/mo**	**4 500 TND/mo**	3 200 TND/mo
Min commitment	One-shot	3 months	3 months	2 months
Brand system	Full buildout	Full (included M1)	Full + monthly refresh	Light (creative system only)
Deliverables / month	8 short videos + brand kit	12 shorts + 2 product / UGC-style	20 shorts + 2 long-form + 1 on-location shoot	12 ad-creative variants (3 angles × 4 hooks)
On-location production	1 half-day	Quarterly half-day	Monthly half-day	—
Strategy	—	Async hook / script feedback	Weekly 30-min strategy call	Bi-weekly creative scoring
Performance review	—	—	Monthly + ad performance	CTR / hook-rate scoring
Turnaround	5–7 days	3–5 days	48–72h priority	72h per batch
Delivery hours / month	~25h total	~35h	~70h	~30h
Capacity / partner	1 active sprint	2 retainers	1 retainer	2 retainers
Outcome the client buys	"I have a brand to launch with."	"I post consistently in a recognizable system."	"I have a fractional content team."	"My ads stop dying after 2 weeks."

> **Two design notes that matter:**
> **1.** The **Identity Sprint** exists to seed retainers, not to be a profit center. Pitch it as "*month-one of Content OS, paid separately*" — target 70%+ upgrade rate.
> **2.** The **Ad Creative Pack** is the e-com on-ramp. Founders don't buy "branded content" — they buy *ads that scale*. Pricing it separately lets you sell to brands not ready for full Content OS.

On-location production: a real cost line

Service businesses don't have raw footage to send. Build a **half-day shoot template**: 4 hours on-site = 30+ short clips of staff, space, procedures, testimonials → fuels one month of content. Either one partner shoots while the other backs up files in real-time, or partner with a videographer at 90–150 TND / half-day. Build it into the price; never quote it separately.

3 · Revenue model

Why low-ticket volume is rejected

15 one-off video packs at 200 TND each = 3 000 TND, but it produces zero recurrence, zero leverage, and burnout in week three. It also contradicts the "system" positioning — discounting destroys credibility. We do not pursue this path.

Three viable paths to 3 000+ TND MRR (high-ticket, fewer clients)

Path	Mix	MRR	When
Floor (M3 target)	2 × Content OS	**5 000 TND**	Month 3
Realistic (M4–5)	1 Performance + 1 Content OS + 1 Ad Pack	**10 200 TND**	Month 4–5
Stretch (M6)	2 Performance + 1 Content OS + 1 Ad Pack	**14 700 TND**	Month 6

> **Capacity rule:** cap at **4 active retainers**. Past that, hire a contractor or refuse work. Premium positioning fails the moment delivery quality slips.

The one metric to watch

MRR (Monthly Recurring Revenue from retainers). Not followers. Not DMs sent. Not video views. Retainer count × average ticket = the only number that tells you the system is working.

"Working" threshold: MRR grows ≥ 30% month-over-month for the first 4 months. If it doesn't, the bottleneck is *acquisition*, not delivery.

4 · Client acquisition system

Bullseye narrowing — pick three channels, double down on whichever produces a paying client first

Channel	Why test it	Effort
IG cold DM (personalized)	Buyers are on IG, you can show portfolio inline	30 DMs/week (split between partners)
IG / TikTok studio account	Demonstrates the work itself = best proof	3 reels/week
LinkedIn (FR-speaking founders)	Cleaner buying intent, less noise than IG	2 posts/week

Cut on day 1: SEO (too slow), Google Ads (no LTV data yet), YouTube (production cost), prospecting low-LTV local businesses.

Free e-com prospecting workflow (2 hours, 60–80 qualified leads)

1. Open **Meta Ad Library** → filter Tunisia → keyword by category (cosmétique, mode, supplément, déco…)
2. Any brand running ads for 30+ days = has budget, has bad creative.
3. Add to Notion sheet → check IG follower count > 5k → score by ad longevity.
4. Cold DM with a reference to their actual ad — generic outreach is invisible to them.

Service-business prospecting

- Google Maps + filter by category (clinique esthétique Tunis, etc.)
- Cross-reference with Instagram presence (must already post regularly)
- LinkedIn search for "fondateur / directeur" of those orgs
- **Local agency partnerships** — many Tunisian agencies sell SEO/ads but outsource video. Be their video partner, not their competitor.

Outreach scripts (FR)

DM — E-COMMERCE FOUNDER

> Salut [Prénom], j'ai vu vos pubs sur Meta — celle de [produit spécifique] tourne depuis 6 semaines, c'est solide.
>
> Le problème que la plupart des marques tunisiennes ont à votre échelle : la créa fatigue vite (CTR qui chute, CPM qui monte) parce qu'on tourne 2-3 vidéos et on les pousse à mort.
>
> On construit des systèmes créatifs pour des marques DTC : 12 variations d'ads par mois, structurées par angle (preuve sociale, problème, démo, lifestyle), pour qu'on ait toujours une créa fraîche à pousser. Identité de marque préservée sur toutes les variations.
>
> Je peux vous envoyer un audit gratuit de vos 5 dernières pubs avec 3 angles inexploités — ça vous intéresse ?

DM / LINKEDIN — PREMIUM SERVICE BUSINESS

> Bonjour [Prénom], j'ai vu le compte Instagram de [Cabinet/Clinique]. Vous publiez régulièrement, c'est rare dans votre secteur en Tunisie.
>
> Une observation : vos vidéos sont produites comme du contenu personnel, alors que votre clientèle attend une image qui rassure (vos confrères en France/UAE ont un standard visuel beaucoup plus haut, et ça se voit dans le taux de conversion en RDV).
>
> On construit des systèmes de contenu pour des cabinets / centres premium : identité visuelle, scripts cadrés, tournages mensuels sur place. Une vidéo doit faire prendre RDV, pas juste générer des likes.
>
> Si vous êtes ouvert, je peux vous envoyer un audit de vos 5 derniers posts avec 3 leviers concrets pour augmenter le RDV par vidéo.

4 · Acquisition (cont.)

The audit is the real sales asset

Each free audit is a 5-minute Loom + a 1-page mockup:

- Walk-through of their 5 latest videos / ads
- **3 specific fixes** (color inconsistency, hook structure, pacing)
- 1 mockup of how their next reel could look in a fixed system

The audit is the moment they realize you think differently. Build a Loom template once; reuse forever.

Weekly acquisition rhythm (combined for both partners)

Day	Activity	Owner
Mon	Plan: 30 prospects scouted in Notion	Partner A
Tue–Fri	8 DMs / day (4 each) + reply management	Both
Wed	1 IG reel posted (BTS / case study / fix)	Partner B
Fri	1 LinkedIn carousel + 1 IG reel	Partner A
Sat	5 audits sent to warm leads	Both
Sun	Weekly review: replies, calls booked, MRR delta	Both

Funnel benchmarks & failure points

Stage	Conversion target	If below → fix
DM sent → reply	25%	Tighten hook line; reference specific ad / post
Reply → audit accepted	50%	Audit not specific enough — add named angle
Audit → call booked	40%	No clear CTA in the Loom
Call → close	30%	Pricing or proof problem (case study gap)

30 DMs/week × these rates ≈ 0.45 closes/week ≈ 2 closes/month at steady state.
Service businesses have ~30% lower reply rates but ~30% higher close rates once on a call — plan around that.

5 · Delivery system (operational workflow)

Phase 1 — Onboarding (days 1–10 of any new client)

Day	Action	Output
D1	Discovery call (45 min)	Filled brief in Notion
D2	Brand audit doc	5-slide audit shared
D3–7	System buildout	Color palette, typo, editing style guide, 3 Premiere templates, hook bank (50 hooks)
D8	Approval call	Signed-off style guide
D9–10	First content batch shot / sourced	Production starts

Phase 2 — Monthly recurring cycle

- **Week 1:** Content research + scripts / concepts (≈ 10h)
- **Week 2:** Batch produce 1 (50% of deliverables)
- **Week 3:** Batch produce 2 (remaining + revisions)
- **Week 4:** Final batch + monthly review call + plan next month

Tool stack (lean, every cost defensible)

Layer	Tool	Cost (TND/mo)	Why
Editing	Adobe Creative Cloud (1 shared)	~80	Industry standard, defensible
Review	Frame.io (free tier)	0	Timecoded comments → fewer revision rounds
Client portal	Notion	0	One page per client → less back-and-forth
Internal PM	ClickUp (free)	0	Task ownership, deadlines
AI voice	ElevenLabs	~30	Voiceovers without recording
AI script / research	ChatGPT Plus (1 shared)	~70	Hook ideation, research synthesis
Stock	Envato Elements	~50	B-roll + music licensed
Comms	WhatsApp Business or Slack Connect	0	One channel per client; no email chaos
Total tooling		**≈ 230**	Recoverable on first retainer

File structure (every client identical)

```
/Clients/[ClientName]/
  00_Brand_System/     ← style guide, palette, templates
  01_Source/           ← raw footage from client
  02_Working/          ← .prproj, .aep
  03_Renders/          ← exported drafts
  04_Delivered/        ← final, dated MP4s
  05_Research/         ← hooks, references, scripts
  06_Comms/            ← call recordings, briefs
```

Communication rules (kill scope creep before it starts)

- **One channel per client** (WhatsApp Business OR Slack Connect — pick once, stick).
- **Async-first.** Calls only at onboarding + monthly review.
- **Templated Monday status update** (3 lines: shipped / in progress / blocked).
- **Revisions:** bundled, 1 round per deliverable, 24h client window. Past that, locked.

Three operational moves that compound (the moat)

1. **On-location production becomes core** — service businesses can't send footage; build the half-day shoot template once.
2. **UGC brief library for e-com** — 10 reusable briefs (unboxing, before/after, problem-solution, testimonial, demo) you hand to the client's UGC creators. You edit; they shoot.
3. **Ad performance loop** (Performance & Ad Pack tiers) — read-only access to client's Meta Ads Manager → pull CTR, thumb-stop rate, hook rate weekly → next month's creative briefed *from data, not taste*. No Tunisian editor does this. It's your moat.

6 · Differentiation & positioning

April Dunford positioning

Competitive alternatives	Freelance editors (Fiverr, Malt), in-house intern, full-service marketing agencies.
Unique attributes	Build the brand + editing system *before* producing. Operate it as a recurring retainer. Briefs driven by performance data.
Value (so what)	Every video compounds the brand instead of starting from zero. Recognizable in 2 seconds — even without face-cam.
Who cares most	Brands and service businesses producing 4+ videos/week who already feel the cost of inconsistency.
Market category	**Content System Studio** — not "video editor", not "agency".

Positioning statement (use verbatim in bio & pitch)

> *"We're a creative system studio for Tunisian DTC brands and premium service businesses. We design your visual system once, then produce the videos and ads that run inside it every month — built from your performance data, not from taste. We don't sell videos. We sell more revenue per dirham of ad spend or per square meter of clinic."*

Three messages to repeat across every channel

Pillar	Proof point in content
"Vidéos qui font vendre, pas vidéos qui font des vues."	Side-by-side reel: 3 random brands vs. 3 of your clients
"Vos pubs meurent en 2 semaines parce qu'il n'y a pas de système créatif derrière."	Carousel of ad-fatigue curves with vs. without a system
"On ne crée pas du contenu — on construit la machine qui le produit."	BTS reel showing the style-guide deliverable in action

Words to ban from every channel

Never write or say **"video editing," "montage vidéo,"** or **"freelance editor"** in your bio, DMs, or sales calls. Those words are poison for your pricing.

7 · Profit & investment structure

Avoid 50/50. It breaks the moment one partner outworks the other. Use a **contribution-weighted** model from day one.

Monthly waterfall

```
Revenue
  − Shared costs (Adobe, AI, stock, hosting)
  − Reinvestment bucket (sliding scale, see below)
= Profit pool
  → 40% Base   (split 50/50)        ← rewards partnership, sales, ops
  → 60% Variable (split by hours)    ← rewards execution
```

Worked example — month 4, 5 000 TND revenue

Line	Amount (TND)
Revenue	5 000
− Shared costs	−300
− Reinvestment (20%)	−940
Profit pool	**3 760**
Base 40% (split 50/50)	1 504 → 752 each
Variable 60% (hours: A 60h, B 40h)	2 256 → A 1 354, B 902
Take-home	**A: 2 106 / B: 1 654**

Track hours in a shared Google Sheet (or Toggl). Reconcile last day of every month.

Reinvestment policy (sliding scale)

MRR (TND)	Reinvest	Take-home
0 – 3 000	50%	50% (recover initial tool spend)
3 000 – 6 000	30%	70%
6 000 – 10 000	20%	80%
10 000+	15%	85% (fund first hire)

What to reinvest in (in order)

1. Adobe annual prepaid (~25% discount vs. monthly)
2. Better mic / SSDs / second monitor — for whichever partner is the bottleneck
3. ChatGPT Pro / Topaz Video AI / specialized tools
4. Paid IG account growth (only after month 4)

5. First contractor (junior editor) to free both partners for sales

8 · Six-month roadmap

Month	Focus	Milestones	MRR target
M1	Foundation + first proof	Niche locked. **2 free spec case studies** — 1 e-com brand + 1 premium service business — in exchange for results data + testimonial + footage rights. Tool stack live. Notion portal template built. 1 paid pilot at 50% off.	0 paid ~1 100 TND one-shot
M2	First real retainer	Daily outbound rhythm (15 DMs/day combined). Meta Ad Library scraping weekly. 5 audits sent / week. IG studio account at 20+ posts. **First retainer should be e-com** (faster sales cycle).	**2 500 TND**
M3	Hit the floor	Land first service-business retainer. Now you have a case study in *each* segment. Refine onboarding doc + style-guide template.	**5 000 TND** FLOOR HIT
M4	Optimize delivery	Premiere template library cuts edit time 30%. Raise prices for new clients (Core → 2 700, Premium → 4 800). **Decide segment focus by close rate.** If e-com closes faster → double down. If service businesses close at higher ticket → double down. Don't keep both equal.	**7 000 TND**
M5	Move upmarket	First Performance Partner retainer (4 500+ TND). Partner with 1 Tunisian marketing agency (they sell ads, you do video) → recurring referral pipeline. Hire first contractor (~800 TND/mo) for Tier-1 work.	**9 000 TND**
M6	Scale decision	3–4 active retainers. Sales asset live (portfolio site + 2 case studies with real numbers). Decide: stay lean (2 partners + 1 contractor) or build a 3-person team. Sunset Ad Creative Pack if Performance Partner has won.	**10 000+ TND**

The decision point at month 4: if both segments are converting equally, you don't have focus — you have a coin flip. Pick the one with the higher close rate *or* the higher ticket and concentrate outreach there. Generalists die in Tunisia; specialists win.

9 · What to cut — saying no is half the value

Every "no" below protects the system. Each one is a real temptation that has killed early-stage studios.

Don't do this	Why
✗ **Build a website in M1–M3**	IG profile + Notion case studies = enough. Premature web spend is procrastination dressed as productivity.
✗ **Run paid ads before M5**	No LTV data → no defensible CAC. Spending without LTV is gambling.
✗ **Take one-off video gigs for cash**	Kills capacity for the retainer that compounds. Every transactional gig is two weeks you couldn't sell a retainer.
✗ **Offer standalone logo design**	Low margin. Dilutes positioning. Brand designers do it better.
✗ **Price foreign clients in TND**	Always EUR/USD. Your geography is a discount, not a posted price.
✗ **Go 50/50 profit split on day 1**	Bake the contribution split in *before* resentment shows up. Hours-based variable component is the safety valve.
✗ **Pitch "video editing" anywhere**	The word is poison for your pricing. Bio, DM, call — never use it.
✗ **Take a single low-LTV local business**	They'll churn, badmouth pricing, and waste a case-study slot. Disqualify on the call. No exceptions, even at full price.
✗ **Pitch e-com brands without referencing their actual ads**	Generic outreach to e-com founders is invisible. Specificity (you saw their Meta ad, you know their angle) is the entire game.

The qualifier rule, restated

> Before any sales call, write the answer to **one question**: *"What's this prospect's average customer worth to them?"* If you can't answer ≥ 1 500 TND with confidence, the call ends as a polite decline. You don't need every client. You need the **right four**.

Executive summary (one page)

THE BET

Position as a "Content System Studio," not a video editor. Build brand+editorial systems first, then produce in them as a recurring retainer. Premium ticket, fewer clients, deeper relationships.

WHO WE SELL TO

Tunisian DTC e-commerce (cosmetics, fashion, supplements — running Meta ads) and **premium service businesses** (clinics, real estate, education). Qualifier: avg customer LTV ≥ 1 500 TND.

WHAT WE SELL

4 SKUs: Identity Sprint (1 800 one-shot) · **Content OS (2 500/mo)** · Performance Partner (4 500/mo) · Ad Creative Pack (3 200/mo).

HOW WE GET CLIENTS

3 channels: IG cold DM (referencing their actual ads/posts), studio IG/TikTok account, LinkedIn for FR-speaking founders. Free 5-min audit Loom = the real sales asset.

THE METRIC

MRR. Threshold: ≥ 30% MoM growth for 4 months. Cap at 4 active retainers — past that, hire or refuse.

THE 6-MONTH DESTINATION

10 000+ TND MRR from 3–4 retainers, 1 contractor, 1 agency referral partnership. Floor of 3 000 TND hit by month 3.

The five rules that protect the system

1. **The qualifier rule** — every prospect's customer must be worth ≥ 1 500 TND to them.
2. **The capacity rule** — never more than 4 active retainers per 2 partners.
3. **The vocabulary rule** — never say "video editing" or "montage vidéo".
4. **The retainer rule** — no transactional gigs once 2 retainers are signed.
5. **The split rule** — 40% base / 60% hours-variable from day 1, no exceptions.